09-24 第2篇

阅读理解（说明文） Why Do We Need to Sleep?

① Every night, about one third of your life quietly disappears. A Grade-8 student who sleeps **eight hours a day** will, by the age of fifteen, have spent **five full years** asleep. From the outside, sleep can look a little strange — even wasteful. Why would the long, clever process of **evolution** let humans and most animals switch off for hours, every night, unable to run, hunt, study or defend themselves? The answer is becoming clearer each year: sleep is **not a stop in life, but a second kind of working day** for the body and the brain.

② First, sleep is the time when the **body repairs itself**. Your heart beats more slowly during deep sleep; your muscles relax; and your body releases a hormone called **growth hormone**, which helps children grow taller and helps the small injuries of the day — a sore knee from P.E., a small scratch on the hand — begin to heal. Most of this repair work is done in **deep sleep**, usually during the first half of the night. Athletes know this well: top football players sleep an average of **nine hours** during a championship, much more than ordinary adults. Less deep sleep means slower healing, slower muscle growth, and weaker immune defence against colds and flu.

③ Second, and perhaps more surprising, sleep is when the **brain cleans itself**. During the day, thinking produces tiny **waste products**, a kind of **brain rubbish**, that slowly build up between your brain cells. In 2013, scientists discovered that during sleep, the small spaces between brain cells **grow slightly larger**, and a clear fluid flows through them, washing the waste away. You can think of the brain as a busy factory by day and a **cleaning crew** by night. Without enough sleep, the rubbish stays behind. Over many years, high levels of these products are linked with serious brain diseases such as **Alzheimer's disease**.

④ Third, sleep is when **memories are stored**. During the day, your brain collects huge amounts of information — new English words, a maths step, the name of a new classmate. At night, while you dream, the brain **repeats** these experiences at high speed, decides **which ones matter**, and moves the important ones from **short-term memory** to **long-term memory**. That is one reason a student who sleeps eight hours the night before a Chinese exam usually remembers more than a classmate who sleeps only four — even if both studied for the same total time. Sleep, in a way, is **the second half of studying**.

⑤ Fourth, sleep controls your **mood and self-control**. After a bad night, most teenagers feel more irritable, more likely to argue, more likely to eat sugary snacks, and less able

to focus on a boring task. Brain scans show that a tired brain has a **weaker "brake"** on emotions, so feelings of anger or sadness are harder to manage. A week of 5-hour nights can make a normally cheerful student feel, without any clear reason, heavy and upset. Exam week, unfortunately, is often the very week when students sleep the least — and the very week when a stable mood would help the most.

⑥ Scientists now recommend **8 to 10 hours** of sleep per night for middle-school students. But "how long" is not the only question; "**when**" matters too. Going to bed at **11 p.m. and waking at 7 a.m.** is quite different from going to bed at **2 a.m. and waking at 10 a.m.** — even though both give eight hours. Our bodies follow an **internal clock**, and the deep healing sleep of the first part of the night happens best when we lie down before midnight. Late bedtimes shift this clock, and over weeks they can reduce the quality of the eight hours you think you are getting.

⑦ A few simple habits can protect your sleep. Try to go to bed and wake up at **roughly the same time** each day, even on weekends. Avoid **bright screens** — phones, tablets, bright study lamps — for **30 — 60 minutes** before bed; bright light tells the brain it is still morning. Keep the bedroom **cool, dark and quiet**. Save caffeinated drinks such as strong tea and cola for the morning, not the evening.

⑧ In the end, sleep is not a **luxury** for hard-working students. It is a second kind of school — one in which the body repairs, the brain cleans, the memory sorts, and the mood resets. A student who skips sleep to study is, without realising it, **closing one classroom to spend longer in another**. The students who grow strongest, remember longest, and keep calmest, are usually not the ones who work the most hours; they are the ones who **work hard by day, and then sleep well at night**.

注释： evolution 进化；hormone 激素；immune 免疫的；Alzheimer's disease 阿尔茨海默症；internal clock 生物钟；caffeinated 含咖啡因的

根据文章内容，选择最佳答案。

1. Why does the writer call sleep "not a stop in life, but a second kind of working day" (Paragraph 1)?

A. Because people can still work their normal jobs during sleep.
B. Because many important body and brain processes — repair, cleaning, memory sorting, mood reset — only happen well during sleep; sleep is another kind of active work.
C. Because sleep is a waste of time.
D. Because humans never actually sleep.

2. According to Paragraph 2, which is NOT a function of deep sleep?

A. The body releases growth hormone, helping children grow and small injuries heal.
B. The heart beats more slowly and muscles relax.
C. The immune system is strengthened to fight colds and flu.
D. The student gets taller quickly by running in dreams.

3. What do scientists say about the brain "cleaning itself" in Paragraph 3?

A. The brain produces no waste.
B. During sleep, the small spaces between brain cells grow slightly larger and a clear fluid flows through, washing away waste products linked with diseases such as Alzheimer's.
C. The brain is dead during sleep.
D. Only the heart, not the brain, is active at night.

4. Why is sleep called "the second half of studying" (Paragraph 4)?

A. Because students must study during sleep.
B. Because at night, the brain repeats the day's information, decides which memories matter, and moves the important ones from short-term to long-term memory.
C. Because sleep replaces all classroom learning.
D. Because teachers give homework in dreams.

5. According to the last paragraphs, which is a TRUE piece of advice about sleep?

A. Go to bed at any time — only the total hours matter.
B. Use bright screens right before bed to help you relax.
C. Try to go to bed and wake up at roughly the same time each day, avoid bright screens for 30—60 minutes before bed, and keep the bedroom cool, dark and quiet.
D. Drink strong tea at 11 p.m. so that you sleep deeper.

答案与解析

1.
【答案】B
【题型】段落主旨题
【定位】第①段 "sleep is not a stop in life, but a second kind of working day"
【解析】睡眠是身体与大脑的另一种工作状态。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

2.
【答案】D
【题型】细节判断题
【定位】第②段三大作用
【解析】"跑步做梦促生长"纯属虚构。A、B、C 均为原文所述。故选 D。

3.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第③段 "small spaces between brain cells grow slightly larger ... washing the waste away ... Alzheimer's disease"
【解析】睡眠时脑细胞间隙扩大以清洗代谢物。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

4.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第④段 "brain repeats ... decides which ones matter ... short-term memory to long-term memory"
【解析】夜间整理与巩固当日记忆。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

5.
【答案】C
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第⑦段 "roughly the same time each day ... avoid bright screens ... cool, dark and quiet"
【解析】C 总结睡眠卫生要点。A、B、D 与原文相悖。故选 C。